



Continuous production

During continuous production, a product is made 24 hours a day, seven days a week. The production line runs continuously to cope with demand, and staff work around the clock in shifts.

How it works

With flow or mass production, the line is stopped to change products or models. Continuous production uses the same concept, but it runs throughout the year so output is nonstop. This method is used for identical commodities with high, consistent demand, including paper, cardboard, packaging, laundry detergent,

electronic components, and oil products. As with mass production, processes are automated, staffing levels are kept to a minimum, and quality control is essential.

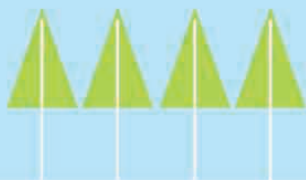
There is high competition in industries using continuous production. Margins may be low, but demand is often relatively stable, encouraging investment in capital equipment.

The paper trail

Paper is used throughout the world, and factories operate 365 days a year to satisfy constant demand. Lumber is the raw material for papermaking. Once the lumber has been debarked, chipped, and pulped, the fibers are washed and dyed. At the end of its life cycle, some paper is recycled.

Wood

Lumber is a renewable resource and logs are stockpiled. Trucks make constant deliveries to processors for pulping.



Paper recycling

Recycled paper is an important resource for the paper industry.



Papermaking

In this continuous process, automated machinery runs 24 hours a day, 365 days a year.



HEADBOX

Fiber and water are fed onto a moving wire mesh.

WIRE SECTION

Some of the water is sucked away to leave wet fibers that form paper.

